

As I went down to the river to pray

Text: African American Spiritual

Music: African American Spiritual

AS I WENT DOWN TO THE RIVER TO PRAY irregular

The musical score is written for a single melodic line on a treble clef staff in B-flat major (one flat). The time signature is 2/2. The melody is composed of eighth and quarter notes, with some triplets. Chord diagrams are provided above the staff at various points, indicating the harmonic accompaniment. The lyrics are written below the staff, with some words hyphenated across lines. The score ends with a double bar line and the word 'D.C.' (Da Capo).

As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way,
and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.
1 Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.
Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray.

2. Oh, brothers, ...

3. Oh, children, ...

4. Oh, sinners, ...